

PERI OZTEKIN

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PROFILE

High school student pursuing an accelerated, neuroscience-focused academic program through Florida Virtual School, supplemented by university-level coursework from HarvardX and a competitive clinical neuroscience immersion at Stanford. Long-term interests center on systems and clinical neuroscience, brain-computer interfaces, and the translation of neuroscience research into accessible educational content. Strong record of independent, self-directed learning with sustained commitment to advanced STEM and brain science.

EDUCATION

Florida Home Education Program (Florida Unschoolers)

Fall 2025 – Spring 2026

Cumulative Grade Point Average: 4.00/4.00

- Individualized, neuroscience-centered academic program operating under Florida's home education statute; coursework completed through Florida Virtual School (FLVS Flex), an accredited statewide public virtual school providing graded instruction and official transcripts.
- Coursework completed: Honors Biology (A), Honors Chemistry (A), Honors Physics (A), Honors English 1 (A), Honors World History (A), Honors Algebra 1 (A), Honors Algebra 2 (A), Honors Geometry (A), Honors Advanced IT (A), Honors Foundations of Web Design (A), French I (A).
- Ongoing coursework: Honors Economics (A), Honors English 2 (A), Honors Personal Finance and Money Management (A), Honors United States History (A), Honors United States Government (A), French 2 (A).

HarvardX – MicroBachelors® Program in Introduction to Neuroscience

Spring 2026

Harvard University Online (edX) | University-level, four-course sequence

- Completed Fundamentals of Neuroscience, Part 1 (Electrical Properties of the Neuron), Part 2 (Neurons and Networks), Part 3 (The Brain), and Part 4 (Proctored Final Exam) — all four certificates earned.
- Coursework spans cellular and molecular neuroscience, action potentials, synaptic transmission, neural circuits, sensory systems, neuromodulation, and the consequences of brain injury.
- Develops analytical reasoning, quantitative interpretation of neuroscience data, and problem-solving skills at the college level; culminates in a proctored final exam with eligibility for transferable college credit.

Stanford University – Clinical Neuroscience Immersion Experience (CNI-X)

Summer 2025

Department of Psychiatry & Behavioral Sciences | Two-week intensive summer program

- Selected through a highly competitive admissions process; participated as the youngest student admitted to the cohort as a rising freshman.
- Engaged directly with Stanford medical faculty across topics in neuroscience, clinical neuropsychiatry, neuroscience research methodology, psychiatric epidemiology, and behavioral and social sciences.
- Co-developed A.R.A.I.A., a six-person team capstone project: an AI-powered aphasia rehabilitation application designed to deliver personalized, evidence-based speech therapy to stroke survivors, integrating clinically-supported therapy techniques with adaptive AI and accessibility-first design. Contributed equally with team members across research, design, and presentation; final project presented to Stanford faculty, staff, and families.

CERTIFICATIONS & VERIFIED CREDENTIALS

- **HarvardX – Fundamentals of Neuroscience, Part 1:** The Electrical Properties of the Neuron (Certificate: February 2026)
- **HarvardX – Fundamentals of Neuroscience, Part 2:** Neurons and Networks (Certificate: March 2026)
- **HarvardX – Fundamentals of Neuroscience, Part 3:** The Brain (Certificate: March 2026)
- **HarvardX – Fundamentals of Neuroscience, Part 4:** Final Exam (Certificate: March 2026)
- **Stanford University:** Clinical Neuroscience Immersion Experience (July 21 – August 1, 2025) (Certificate: August 2025)
- **Information Technology Specialist – Python:** Certiport / Pearson VUE (May 2, 2025).
- **Information Technology Specialist – Device Configuration and Management:** Certiport / Pearson VUE (June 2, 2025).
- **Information Technology Specialist – HTML and CSS:** Certiport / Pearson VUE (May 8, 2024).

RESEARCH & INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

NEUROSENSE — Source-Locked Neuroscience Education Pipeline

Ongoing

Independent research and content design project

- Designed a three-layer educational content pipeline that translates peer-reviewed and primary-source neuroscience material (drawing on Huberman Lab Podcast transcripts) into age-appropriate, engaging short-form content for younger learners.
- Pipeline architecture enforces scientific fidelity through atomic claim extraction with timestamps, constrained vocabulary simplification that preserves causal and temporal logic, and annotated metaphor layers with explicit transformation notes.
- Goal: support neuroscience literacy in pre-college audiences without compromising mechanistic accuracy — directly relevant to translational science communication.

Independent Reading in Neuroscience & Brain Plasticity

Ongoing

- Sustained independent reading across systems neuroscience, neuroplasticity, sleep and circadian biology, and the neurobiology of learning — building foundational fluency for journal-club discussion of neuroscience literature and engagement with Grand Rounds-style clinical research presentations.

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

- **Neuroscience knowledge:** Cellular neuroscience, neuronal electrophysiology, neural circuits, sensory systems, neuromodulation, fundamentals of clinical neuropsychiatry.
- **Scientific reasoning:** Reading and interpreting primary research literature, evaluating experimental design, integrating mechanistic concepts across cellular, systems, and behavioral levels.
- **Quantitative & technical:** Programming and algorithmic reasoning developed through extracurricular IMACS coursework and validated by professional ITS certifications in Python, Device Configuration and Management, and HTML & CSS; comfort with quantitative neuroscience data interpretation.
- **Communication:** Strong English writing and oral expression; conversational French (FLVS French I–II); experience presenting collaborative work to Stanford faculty at CNI-X.
- **Work habits:** Independent, self-directed learner under a non-traditional academic structure; proven ability to manage rigorous coursework and externally validated programs in parallel.

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

Institute for Mathematics and Computer Science (IMACS)

Elementary – Middle School

- Multi-year extracurricular coursework in mathematics, formal logic, and computer science, building foundational algorithmic and programming skills; plans to resume IMACS at the college-level computer science track in support of computational neuroscience goals.

Peer Counseling & National Junior Honor Society (NJHS)

Middle School

- Trained peer counselor; member of NJHS, contributing to school-based community service initiatives and academic mentoring.

YouTube Educational Content Creator

Ongoing

- Develops short-form educational content focused on accessible explanation of complex topics; aligned with NEUROSENSE pipeline and broader neuroscience outreach interest.

Piano, Taekwondo, and Leadership in Training (LIT) Camp

Ongoing

- Long-term piano studies and Taekwondo (American Tigers Martial Arts – High Red Belt), developing discipline and resilience; Leadership in Training (LIT) Camp building peer leadership skills.